

ISSUE 01 · PERSONAL KNOWLEDGE STACK

The Lazy Obsidian Method

A clear setup for turning messy notes into a useful AI second brain.

At the centre is Andrej Karpathy's LLM-wiki idea: keep raw source material, process what matters, and slowly turn it into structured, connected knowledge. The support layer around it — structure, search, graph, recurring jobs — is what makes it useful.

The stack at a glance

LAYER	TOOL	WHAT IT DOES
Vault	Obsidian	Local-first markdown notes. The home base.
Method	Karpathy LLM wiki	Capture raw → process → link → compound.
Structure	PARA	Projects, Areas, Resources, Archive.
Workflow	Obsidian Skills	Kepano's patterns for working inside the vault.
Graph	Graphify	Surfaces clusters, key nodes, relationships.
Search	QMD	Better markdown retrieval as the vault grows.

The lazy unlock: recurring jobs

What keeps the system alive without making maintenance a job.

CADENCE	INPUTS	OUTPUTS	PURPOSE
Daily ingest	Web clips, notes, voice memos	Cleaned notes, wiki-ready pages, ingest summary	Get messy inputs in — don't overthink.
Nightly review	Daily notes, lessons, agent logs & memory	Refreshed dashboards, memory updates, backups	Tidy-up + the critical priority refresh.
Weekly vault	Memory, dashboards, topic gaps	Weekly review, gaps list, next-step items	Set focus areas for the coming week.

“Capture messy. Process later. Let the vault improve over time.”

How to set it up

#	STEP	NOTES
01	Set up PARA folders	Only critical if you have no structure. Align your agents to it.
02	Create the Obsidian vault	Give your agent the relevant skills. Ask how it'd work best.

03	Capture raw, fast	Clips, notes, ideas into a raw folder — Karpathy-style.
04	Promote with the LLM-wiki method	Turn the useful raw into linked, structured pages.
05	Add Obsidian Skills	Practical vault workflows from Kepano.
06	Add Graphify	Make the graph view actually informative.
07	Add QMD	Cleaner search and retrieval at scale.
08	Build custom hubs	Projects, research, workflows, agent logs, OS.
09	Wire daily / nightly / weekly jobs	The maintenance layer, automated.
10	Review & refine	Watch outputs. Trim what's noisy. Keep what compounds.

References

RESOURCE	LINK
Obsidian	obsidian.md
Steph Ango / Kepano	stephango.com
Obsidian Skills	github.com/kepano/obsidian-skills
Karpathy LLM wiki	gist.github.com/karpathy
PARA Method	fortelabs.com/blog/para
Graphify	github.com/safishamsi/graphify
QMD	github.com/tobi/qmd

The goal isn't a perfect second brain on day one. It's a system that's easy to use, easy to maintain, and useful enough that it keeps getting better in the background — so your notes stay yours, for whatever you want.